CHAPTER 2

THE ORE DOCK

DULUTH, MINNESOTA · 1938–1950

On Tin Pails and Tunnels

Ruth Calder was born in Duluth, Minnesota, in 1938.

When she was seven or eight, as best she remembered, Ruth walked her father's lunch down to the ore dock in a tin pail. The dock was so tall "you had to tip your head all the way back," and the trains ran right out on top of it. Whether it frightened her, she never quite settled: "No. Well, yeah. A little."

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The big snow came around 1950, as Ruth remembered it. The school closed for a week, and she and her brother Pete dug a tunnel from the porch to the street. Pete proposed that they live in it. "Mother did not agree."

ILLUSTRATION (GENERATED): AN ORE BOAT LOADING AT A DULUTH ORE DOCK IN WINTER [[P001]]